

Netflix Movie Catalog Analysis (2012-2016)

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Executive Summary

This analysis examines movie data from 2012 to 2016 to uncover which genres deliver the best financial performance. We compared budget, revenue and net profit margin across genres to identify:

- Which movie categories yield the highest profitability?
- Which genres are the most cost-effective for acquisition?
- How spending patterns relate to box-office success?

Context

Studios and filmmakers invest millions of dollars into producing and promoting movies. Some movies perform better than others. Our goal is to use data to inform decision making.

Methodology

We used Google Sheets and Excel to perform calculations, generate pivot tables and bar charts, remove irrelevant columns, and standardize data formats. Tableau was used to create the data visualizations in our presentation and one-pager.

Considerations

We have to be mindful of the relevance of our findings, as the dataset is only representative of movies released in 2012-2016. Furthermore, data for 2016 does not completely represent the entire year because the dataset does not include movies released after August 2016.

Key Findings

- The movie industry's health is determined by the rate at which budget and revenue change comparatively for the typical movie. From 2012-2016, the top three genres in terms of volume of movies produced were: Action, Comedy, and Drama.
- Documentaries and Horror movies are the most profitable, while Biographies and Crime movies are the least profitable. Action films generated the highest total revenue (~\$30.5B) with a budget of ~\$10.9B. Adventure and Comedy follow, also yielding nearly 2–3× returns on investment.
- Overall, the industry trend shows that high-budget genres drive the majority of global revenue, while low-budget genres rely on cost efficiency for profitability.

Recommendations

- Adjust business model and budget based on industry and economic conditions.
- Invest more in Horror and Documentaries, less in Crime, and Biographies.
- For more consistent returns, make Action, Comedy, and Drama films.
- Make more sequels, and adaptations of popular franchises.

Conclusion

This analysis revealed key insights in efficiency, genre performance, and profitability. As a result, producers can take steps to be successful in the movie industry.